# BTC 8-Hour Market Report

Friday 23 Oct 2026, 23:50 Malaysia time (15:50 UTC)

**BTC ~ $81,600**

Cointelegraph/TradingView 23:39 MYT | 24h ~flat | 5d -1.1%

| | | | | |
|---|---|---|---|---|
| **Quick view** | **Bias:** Neutral to slightly bearish | **Next 24h range:** $80,000 - $83,000 | **Key floor:** $80,000 (ETF cost basis zone) | **Big event:** FOMC Thu 29 Oct 02:00 MYT, then $11.2B expiry Fri 30 Oct 4pm |

## 1. Options - next 24 hours and upcoming expiries

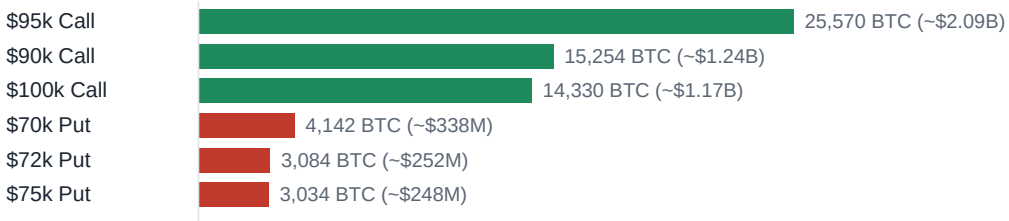
- **Next expiry:** Deribit daily, Sat 24 Oct 4:00pm MYT (08:00 UTC). Dailies are small; no published size was found this run, and it is not expected to move price.
- Today's weekly (Fri 23 Oct 4pm MYT) already settled: ~16,000 BTC, ~$1.28B notional, P/C 1.0, max pain $82,000 - BTC traded near it, around $81.7k, at settlement.
- **The expiry that matters:** Fri 30 Oct 4:00pm MYT monthly (also the weekly) - ~$11.2B notional, P/C 0.56, max pain $78,000. It lands one day after the FOMC decision.

| Expiry | Largest position seen | Size | Meaning |
|---|---|---|---|
| Sat 24 Oct (daily) | No data this run | n/a | Small daily; little pin effect expected over the weekend. |
| 30 Oct (monthly) call | $95,000 call | 25,570 BTC (~$2.09B) | Far above spot (+16%); a ceiling marker, not active until price nears $90k. |
| 30 Oct (monthly) put | $70,000 put | 4,142 BTC (~$338M) | Deep downside hedge; $75k-$76k puts are the nearer, more active put zone. |

### Upcoming expiries

| Expiry (Malaysia time) | Notional | Put/Call | Max pain | Largest strikes |
|---|---|---|---|---|
| Fri 23 Oct 4pm (weekly, settled) | ~$1.28B | 1.00 | $82,000 | Settled near max pain |
| Sat 24 Oct 4pm (daily) | n/a | n/a | n/a | No published data found |
| Fri 30 Oct 4pm (monthly + weekly) | ~$11.2B (136,398 BTC) | 0.56 | $78,000 | Calls $95k, $100k, $90k; puts $70k, $72k, $75k |
| Fri 27 Nov 4pm (next monthly) | ~26,779 BTC (~$2.2B, 17 Oct count) | n/a | n/a | Most active: $98k and $90k calls |

**Fri 30 Oct expiry - largest strikes by open interest (BTC; USD at $81.6k)**




### How options affect the market now

- **No near-term wall:** the big call strikes ($90k-$100k) sit 10-23% above spot, so dealer hedging there is not capping price today. Near spot the book is thin, which lets macro and ETF flows drive the tape.
- **Max pain pull is downward:** 30 Oct max pain has slid from $79k (17 Oct) to $78k (23 Oct), about $3.6k below spot. The pull usually matters only in the final 1-2 days, i.e. after the FOMC.
- **Sentiment split:** open interest is call-heavy (P/C 0.56), but 24h volume P/C rose to 0.77-0.86 - traders are buying fresh protection, with $76k Oct-30 puts among the most traded contracts.
- **Acceleration risk:** if BTC loses $80k, hedgers of the $75k-$76k puts would sell into weakness, which can speed a move toward $78k (max pain) and $75k.

- **Volatility:** implied vol is reported stabilising just above 35% - roughly a 1.8% (~$1,500) one-day move. Expect vol to stay bid into FOMC and drop after the 30 Oct settlement.
- **Today's settlement:** the 23 Oct weekly expired near its $82k max pain, removing a small pin; the weekend daily is too small to matter.

Data note: the Deribit API could not be reached this run, so option figures come from published reports (TokenPost 23 Oct 11:42 UTC snapshot; CryptoTicker 17 Oct strike counts; KuCoin 22 Oct). Strike OI may have changed since 17 Oct - treat as "largest seen". USD sizes = OI x $81,600.

## 2. Price action and key levels

- BTC ~$81,600 at 23:39 MYT; rebounded from an intraday low of $80,988 but is still below the 50-day SMA ($81,781).
- Rejected at $84,000-$84,900 on Wed 21-22 Oct; Thu's Nasdaq -2.6% tech/AI sell-off and record-size ETF outflows dragged price to $81k.
- 24h range roughly $80,989 - $82,800; 5-day change about -1.1%, year-to-date about -7%.
- About $406-431M of crypto liquidations in 24h, mostly longs - leverage flushed but futures OI still rose (+1.7% to $38.4B).

| Type | Level | Why it matters |
|---|---|---|
| Resistance 2 | $84,000 - $84,900 | Range ceiling; this week's rejection highs. |
| Resistance 1 | $82,600 - $82,900 | 20-day EMA / Keltner mid-band; analysts' invalidation level for the bear case. |
| Pivot | $81,800 | 50-day SMA - a daily close above it would neutralise the breakdown. |
| Support | $80,000 - $81,000 | 24h low and the spot ETF investors' average cost basis zone. |
| Deep risk | $78,000 / $75,000 | Oct-30 max pain and lower Keltner band; then short-term holder cost basis and the put cluster. |

## 3. Derivatives, flows and sentiment

| Metric | Latest | Read |
|---|---|---|
| Futures open interest | $38.4B (+1.7%) | Leverage rising while price is flat - fuel for a squeeze either way. |
| Funding rates | Near zero, negative in some snapshots | Longs not crowded on perps; mild contrarian support. |
| Liquidations (24h) | ~$406-431M, mostly longs | Long flush mostly done; largest single was $7.9M on Hyperliquid. |
| Spot BTC ETF flows | Thu 22 Oct -$635.5M | Biggest outflow since late June (IBIT -$254M, FBTC -$217M); Oct MTD ~-$175M. |
| Options P/C (24h volume) | 0.77 - 0.86 (up from 0.75) | Hedging demand rising into FOMC. |
| Fear & Greed | 50 (Neutral), from 68 | Sentiment cooled fast after the sell-off. |
| OKX long/short accounts | 2.25 | Retail still leaning long - room for another flush. |

## 4. News and macro

- **Tech/AI sell-off:** Nasdaq fell 2.6% on Thursday (worst day since June) after Tesla cut capex guidance by 20%; US stocks were lower again Friday (Dow -1.4%).
- **Oil shock:** Brent hit ~$116, highest since March, on Middle East/Houthi tensions; WTI above $102. Inflation and yield risk (10-year US yield near 4.94% Thursday).
- **Consumer data:** UMich sentiment 48.0, near record lows; 1-year inflation expectations up to 4.7%.
- **ETF outflows:** -$635.5M on 22 Oct ended a 3-day, ~$1.08B inflow streak; Monday's flows are the next check.
- **Fed:** FOMC meets 27-28 Oct, policy rate 3.75%-4.00%; Strategy (MSTR) reports 29 Oct.

**Event calendar (Malaysia time)**

| When (MYT) | Event |
|---|---|
| Sat 24 Oct 4:00pm | Deribit daily BTC options expiry (small) |
| Tue 27 Oct 6:00am | US spot BTC ETF flows for Mon 26 Oct published (approx.) |
| Thu 29 Oct 2:00am / 2:30am | FOMC rate decision / Powell press conference |
| Thu 29 Oct 8:30pm | US Q3 GDP (advance) + September PCE inflation |
| Thu 29 Oct (after US close) | Strategy (MSTR) Q3 results |
| Fri 30 Oct 4:00pm | Deribit monthly BTC options expiry (~$11.2B, max pain $78k) |
| Wed 4 Nov (US 3 Nov) | US midterm elections |
| Fri 6 Nov 9:30pm | US October jobs report (US clocks change 1 Nov) |
| Mid-Nov (date to confirm) | US October CPI; next FOMC in December |

## 5. Summary and prediction

BTC is holding $81-82k after Thursday's risk-off hit (Nasdaq -2.6%, $635M ETF outflows, ~$430M long liquidations). The options book offers no nearby wall: big call strikes are far above at $90k-$100k, while the 30 Oct max pain at $78k and rising put buying tilt the medium-term pull lower. Weekend liquidity is thin and the major catalysts (FOMC, PCE, $11.2B expiry) only arrive next week, so a range is the most likely outcome; oil and equity futures are the main risk. **24h call: range-bound $80,000 - $83,000, slight downside tilt while below $81.8k.**

| Scenario | Chance | Range | Trigger |
|---|---|---|---|
| Base: weekend range | 55% | $80,000 - $83,000 | Thin weekend trade, no macro data; price chops around the 50-day SMA. |
| Bullish: reclaim | 20% | $82,800 - $85,000 | Daily close above $82.9k, short covering with funding still neutral, calmer oil. |
| Bearish: $80k breaks | 25% | $77,800 - $80,000 | Hourly close below $80k; oil spike or weak equity futures Monday; pull toward $78k max pain. |

- **Bull signal:** a daily close above $82,900 with rising spot volume opens $84k-$85k.
- **Bear signal:** an hourly close below $80,000 with long liquidations rising targets $78k, then $75k.
- Next report: Sat 24 Oct 7:50am MYT

## Sources

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